SpeechGeek

Season One: Fall 2003

ISSN 1545-9209 Price $25 US
http://www.speechgeek.com

SpeechGeek.com

Season One: Fall 2003

SpeechGeek
ISSN 1545-9209

Corey Alderdice
Editor and Publisher

Stephanie Patterson
Publications Manager

959 Morgantown Rd., Apt. 3
Bowling Green, KY 42101
(270) 705-3632

SpeechGeek is published three to four times per year: August, October, December, and (sometimes) April by Corey Alderdice, 959 Morgantown Rd., Apt. 3, Bowling Green, Kentucky 42101

http://www.speechgeek.com

It is my pleasure to welcome you to the first issue of **SpeechGeek.com**. You may be asking why would we choose a URL as our title? The answer is quite simple. Our goal is to not only use this periodical as a means of furthering forensic performance, but to also create a paper and online environment that aids students at all forensic levels. We believe our material is top quality and ready to help you begin your journey toward becoming a champion. These scripts allow both students and coaches room to be expressive and add his or her own individual ideas. We believe you should be spending your time performing, not looking for quality material. We would love to hear your comments about our first issue. Best of luck as your season begins!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

In This Issue:
Season One: Fall 2003

Humorous Interpretation
Canada, Eh! A Salute to All Things Canuck!
by Frank and Jack Walston.....04

Poetry Interpretation
Being That Guy
by Tony Damico.....09

Duo Interpretation (Male / Female)
The Amazing Presto
by Faith Codge.....14

Duo Interpretation (Male / Male)
The Apology of Socrates
by Odell Workman.....17

Prose Interpretation
Learning to Fall
by Millay McCain.....21

Canada, Eh!

by Frank and Jack Walston

NARR. We begin our story with a...story. (very spectacularish) A long time ago in a barren land filled with great wonder and delight, there lived a wee little man who loved everything around him. The trees, the earth, the cold, cold winters and everything aboot his home land. That's why you should come to Canada...because a wee little man told you to.

EXEC. Nice...I love that feeling of patriotism...yes...proud to be a Canadian. Ahem...so how did the commercial run with the test audiences?

ASST. Umm...sir...the only positive results we had were with chimpanzees and algae...

EXEC. WHY IS THAT?

ASST. Well sir it's just not appealing to any 'human' audience...

EXEC. What does this mean, eh?

ASST. Basically, primates and algae don't spend the dough so I guess the commercial is being pulled.

EXEC. We really have to do something here...I could lose my job...my car...my house...my flannel hat!!

ASST. Sir, I think I have an idea.

EXEC. Yes? Out with it.

ASST. Well while I am frequently watching American television I notice that their advertising campaigns are...well...entertaining...not boring...funny...intelligent...creative..

EXEC. I get the point. What are you saying?

ASST. (Whispers) Let's hire Americans to make our PR campaigns...that way we don't look so bad...

EXEC. OUI!!...I mean YES!! I love it. Lets get on the phone.

JOEL. Good afternoon ladies and gentlemen. On behalf of In Your Face Advertising, it is my pleasure to be here.

COREY. Thank you Joel. My name is Corey and you good people at the Canadian Ministry of Tourism have asked our firm to give your nation a public relations makeover.

JOEL. That's right. Here are the profit numbers from tourism last year. Zero (hold up a zero)

COREY. Fixable...definitely fixable

JOEL. Wait a minute. That's not right. (holds up negative one billion) Negative one billion...right.

COREY. Okay folks that's just bad-(bewildered look)

JOEL. Moving along, we have several ideas that will give your country a nice kick in the pants. So if you're ready, let's begin. We feel it's best to appeal to a new generation. It worked for Pepsi. It worked for Star Trek: The Next Generation. "N-E-X-T" Generation...see what I'm saying? Hmm...you know what I'm talking about.

COREY. You have to give kids what they want. They don't want their grandma's Canada. They want C-N-D wit duh triple A's mixed in...word.

JOEL. (aside) That means Canada.

COREY. Here's a little rap aboot a land called Canada. It's got lots of moose, but we ain't got pan-uh-das...

JOEL. (cuts off) That doesn't even make sense. What I think you were going for is, pandas?

COREY. Look I'm the one bustin' the lyrical rhymes YO! You stick to the beat ah-

The Apology of Socrates

by Odell Workman

TRIPP. Socrates was a philosopher, a visionary of his time.

SOCRATES. I do nothing but go around trying to persuade people to listen. All I care about is the improvement of the soul.

TRIPP. Socrates didn't care what others had to say about himself or his teachings.

SOCRATES. Hey, don't be offended at my speaking the truth. You want the truth? You want the truth? You *can* handle the truth! The truth is...

TRIPP. Socrates would teach from the streets. He would teach in public areas. He would teach wherever there was a single person willing to listen.

SOCRATES. A man who is good for anything should only consider when doing something if it is right or wrong. It's that simple folks.

TRIPP. Socrates didn't claim to know everything. He simply wanted people to listen.

SOCRATES. I don't know everything. Hell, no one knows everything. All I know is that I know enough to know that I don't know everything. You get that?

TRIPP. Socrates was awesome.

WARD. Mr. Lampkin, once again I am less than pleased with your work. Might I remind you that you are no longer at your old high school? You are a student at the prestigious Woodsburg Academy.

TRIPP. It was a dumb assignment. Personally, I don't care about history. It's dead people with dead thoughts. I want something real...alive.

WARD. Real? You want something real? Mr. Lampkin those who fail to learn from the past...

TRIPP. Yeah, are doomed to repeat it. I get you loud and clear.

WARD. I'm afraid that you do not. However, I see our discussion is having little effect on your opinions so I propose a second chance, of sorts.

TRIPP. I don't wanna write another research paper.

WARD. Quite the opposite. I want you to find someone in the community and see what you can learn from this person. Find out who he is. What has shaped herlife?

TRIPP. Anyone that I want?

WARD. Yes, Mr. Lampkin, the choice is yours.

TRIPP. Ok, what's the catch?

WARD. There is no catch, but may I remind you that it is this or failure. Your GPA and hope of remaining with us at Woodsburg rests on this grade. And I'm sure your father would not be pleased with that, now would he? You have two weeks. Dismissed.

TRIPP. Stupid Mr. Reynolds. 'Those who fail to learn from their mistakes are doomed to repeat them.' Now where am I gonna find someone interesting in two weeks?

SOCRATES. Some spare change ma'am. Penny for my thoughts, sir? Is every damn person here deaf or is it just me?

TRIPP. Well, so much for a challenge.

SOCRATES. Why does everyone ignore me? Does anyone have ears to hear, think, or speak? Knowledge is the only real power any of us have. Knowledge for sale! It's goin' cheap!

TRIPP. Here goes everything. Excuse me?

SOCRATES. At last, a student with an eager mind. It's about time. Half price

discount for students today.

TRIPP. Uh...on second thought, never mind.

SOCRATES. Sorry, I didn't mean to startle you. It's not every day that someone actually stops to listen. Name's Eddie, Eddie Thompkins.

TRIPP. Hal Lampkin the third. Friends call me Tripp.

SOCRATES. Nickname, eh? I like it. Well, if we're going by nicknames, friends call me Socrates.

TRIPP. Socrates? Like the philosopher?

SOCRATES. You know any other Socrates? If you do, then I'm in trouble.

TRIPP. (changing subject) Do you do this every day? I mean, stand on a street corner yelling at people?

SOCRATES. You call that yelling? Oh, it's far from yelling. It's teaching, though most people only listen long enough to hear the sound and not the message.

TRIPP. And what kind of message is that?

SOCRATES. Nouns and verbs juxtaposed to the melodic rhythms of the mind. (coughs because Tripp doesn't get it) Everything you really need to know to make it in life.

TRIPP. And how long would it take you to teach me that?

SOCRATES. How long you got?

TRIPP. Two weeks.

SOCRATES. That'll do...That'll do. Meet me here tomorrow for your first lesson.

TRIPP. Mr. Reynolds, I wanted to let you know I found the subject for my project.

WARD. Why Tripp, are you actually showing some initiative?

TRIPP. I guess I was in the right place at the right time. He calls himself Socrates. He's a philosopher, I guess you could say. You may have seen him around town down on...

WARD. I have more than seen him. He was once my colleague...

TRIPP. You mean he was a professor here?

WARD. Emphasis on the word *was*, Mr. Lampkin. And I would recommend you stay away from him.

TRIPP. Why?

WARD. Because he has several problems. Problems that he was unwilling to deal with that caused Professor Thompkins to mentally break down one day during a class. Needless to say he was no longer welcome here.

TRIPP. But he seems harmless.

WARD. Most dangerous individuals do. I know I said anyone, but this is now a matter of liability. I am warning you, for your own safety stay away from Mr. Thompkins or Socrates or whatever he calls himself.

TRIPP. But you said I could choose anyone. You want me to learn and yet it goes right back to what *you* choose for me to learn.

WARD. Fine. And while you are learning about him, ask Socrates what happened that day.

SOCRATES. The student returns for his first lesson.

TRIPP. Look, you wanna tell me how you ended up on the street?

SOCRATES. An eager mind, but most pupils allow the teacher to ask the first question.

TRIPP. Cut the crap. I know what happened at Woodsburg.

SOCRATES. I see. That certainly isn't a moment that I'm proud of. Let's just say I had reached rock bottom and found a way to go deeper. My wife had filed for divorce, I had been told my contract wouldn't be renewed for the following year, and when I stared into twenty blank faces that would rather be watching a shaking Britney Spears than Shakespeare, I lost control.

TRIPP. But how did you wind up on the street?

SOCRATES. Do you really think there's a lot of work out there for a person with a

Master's in philosophy and literature with a history of going crazy and throwing an overhead projector out a window in front of a classroom of students?

TRIPP. Are you ok now?

SOCRATES. Other than the lack of a regular meal and shelter, just peachy. Lesson number one: life isn't something we can control. It can only be dealt with.

TRIPP. I know what you mean.

SOCRATES. Do you? Explain it to me then.

TRIPP. Well, I guess. Just because my dad wants me to go to an Ivy League school like him he ships me off from home to Woodsburg.

SOCRATES. Your father only wants you to receive the best possible education. He wants you to learn.

TRIPP. Learn what? Dates and facts? What good is that to me?

SOCRATES. Absolutely nothing. The problem is you're missing the point. It's not the dates and facts, it's what we are willing to learn from those moments in time—the good decision and the bad ones.

TRIPP. So what did you learn from your bad decision?

SOCRATES. Well, I learned that gravity has a tremendous effect on an overhead thrown from a third story window and I have learned when a student has had enough teaching for one day.

TRIPP. I still have questions.

SOCRATES. All in good time. There's always tomorrow.

TRIPP. I brought you some coffee and a sandwich.

SOCRATES. C'mon. Becoming a teacher's pet isn't going to help your grade one single point.

TRIPP. Can't blame me for trying.

SOCRATES. I'm really surprised at how much you've taken in in such a short time. You really are a remarkable young man.

TRIPP. I feel as though I'm learning for the first time. It just all makes sense.

SOCRATES. Well, I'm glad. Today's your last day and your final lesson.

TRIPP. I hope you saved the best for last.

SOCRATES. Yes, well, I think I did. The unexamined life is not worth living.

TRIPP. Who said that?

SOCRATES. Socrates. The other Socrates. The less good-looking one. Everything that I've been telling you, everything you need to know can easily be discovered. You simply have to look for it.

TRIPP. Have you found it?

SOCRATES. I sure did, but I lost it. (pause) Then I discovered it all over again in a student who reminded me what it was like to teach once more...and what it was like to learn for the first time. I want you to have this. It was always one of my favourite books.

TRIPP. Plato?

SOCRATES. I think you will find interesting. You see, the only legacy Socrates left was through his students. Don't forget what I've taught you Tripp, because you're the beginning of mine.

TRIPP. C'mon. You sound like you're leaving or something.

SOCRATES. That's correct. I have some things to work out, starting with my ex-wife. From there, I'll figure the rest out. I might even try to make it back into a classroom. You head on home and finish your report. I'm sure it'll knock Professor Reynolds' socks off.

TRIPP. Thanks...for everything.

SOCRATES. No, my pupil. Thank you.

TRIPP. (reading the inscription on the inside cover) to my very own Plato.

SOCRATES. It is so often a teacher takes more from his students than is given to them in return...

TRIPP. Thank you for opening my eyes to the world again...

SOCRATES. And thank you for helping me to live the examined life.

Sincerely, Socrates.

TRIPP. Ultimately, Socrates' opponents got the best of him. He was convicted by a jury of Athenians and sentenced to death. It is only from his students that his teachings remain. (beat) I am glad to say that my Socrates' story does not have a sad ending.

SOCRATES. Good morning class. I'm your new Professor, Mr. Thompkins.

TRIPP. I have given you a brief defense of a man who made a bad decision, but looked within himself for change and made up for it by learning to teach anew.

SOCRATES. Can anyone tell me about the philosopher Socrates? Yes, you.

TRIPP. This is my apology of Socrates.